

MERYTA

moisture-retentive but moderately drained soil. Water freely containerized plants in full growth, less at other times. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer or by seed when ripe in late summer.
M. sinclairii (Puka) illus. p.451.

Mesembryanthemum cordifolium.

See *Aptenia cordifolia*.

Mesembryanthemum criniflorum.

See *Cleretum bellidiforme*.

Mesembryanthemum

multiradiatum. See *Lampranthus roseus*.

MESPILUS

Medlar

ROSACEAE

Genus of one species of deciduous tree or shrub, grown for its habit, flowers, foliage, and edible fruits. Fully hardy. Requires sun or partial shade and fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate species by seed in fall and named forms (for fruit) by budding during late summer.

M. germanica illus. p.80. ‘**Nottingham**’ is a compact tree or large shrub. H 20ft (6m), S 25ft (8m). Has lance-shaped to oblong-ovate, dark green leaves, yellow-brown in fall. In late spring and early summer, bears white, sometimes pink-tinged flowers. Produces heavy crops of brown fruit; self-fertile. Z5–8

METASEQUOIA

CUPRESSACEAE

See also CONIFERS.

M. glyptostrobooides (Dawn redwood) illus. p.96.

METROSIDEROS

Pohutakawa, Rata

MYRTACEAE

Genus of dwarf to tall, upright, evergreen, winter-flowering shrubs, trees, and scrambling climbers, grown for their flowers, the trees also for their overall appearance and for shade. Frost hardy to frost tender. Grows in fertile, well-drained soil and in full light. Water containerized specimens freely when in full growth, moderately at other times. Pruning is tolerated if needed. Propagate by seed in spring or by semiripe cuttings in summer.
M. excelsa, syn. *M. tomentosa* (New Zealand fire tree), illus. p.450.
M. robusta (Northern rata, Rata). Robust, evergreen, rounded tree, often epiphytic when young. H 70–80ft (20–25m) or more, S 30–50ft (10–15m). Oblong to elliptic, leathery leaves are dark green and lustrous. Has large clusters of flowers, which are mostly composed of long, dark red stamens, in summer. Z9–11
M. tomentosa. See *M. excelsa*.

MEUM

APIACEAE/UMBELLIFERAE

Genus of clump-forming, summer-flowering perennials, grown for their aromatic leaves. Useful on banks and in wild gardens. Fully hardy. Needs sun and well-drained soil. Propagate by seed when fresh, in fall.

M. athamanticum (Baldmoney, Spignel). Upright perennial. H 6–18in (15–45cm), S 4–6in (10–15cm). Mainly basal and deeply dissected leaves have narrowly linear leaflets. In summer, produces flattish flower heads consisting of clusters of tiny, white or purplish-white flowers. Z6–9

Michelia. See *Magnolia*.

MICROBIOTA

CUPRESSACEAE

See also CONIFERS.

M. decussata (illus. p.105). Spreading, coniferous shrub. H 20in (50cm), S 6–10ft (2–3m). Has green shoots, later turning red-brown, and produces flat sprays of tiny, scalelike, bright, mid-green leaves in symmetrical pairs. Leaves turn bronze in winter. Flowers are inconspicuous. Female, round, yellow-brown cones have only one seed. Z3–7

Microglossa albenscens. See *Aster albenscens*.

MICROMERIA

LAMIACEAE/LABIATAE

Genus of annuals, perennials, and dwarf, evergreen shrubs, suitable for banks and rock gardens. Borderline fully hardy. Needs sun and well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in spring or by softwood cuttings in early summer.

M. juliana. Evergreen, downy, bushy shrub. H and S 1ft (30cm). Small, ovate, aromatic, green leaves are pressed close to the stems. In summer, bears tiny, tubular, bright deep pink flowers in whorls on upper parts of stems. (borderline) Z5–8

MIKANIA

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of evergreen or deciduous, woody-stemmed or herbaceous, scrambling or twining climbers grown for their foliage and flower heads. Frost hardy to frost tender. Needs fertile, well-drained soil and partial shade in summer. Water regularly, less when not in full growth. Stem support is needed. Thin out congested growth in spring. Propagate by semiripe or softwood cuttings in spring. Susceptible to aphids.

M. scandens (Hemp vine). Twining climber, semi- or fully evergreen in tropical areas. H 10–15ft (3–5m). Ovate to triangular, mid-green leaves have 2 basal lobes. Tiny, groundsellike, vanilla-scented, usually white to flesh-pink, or pink to purple, or yellow-tinged white flower heads are borne in compact clusters in from late summer to late fall. Z10–12 (min. 41°F/5°C)

MILIUM

POACEAE/GRAMINEAE

See also GRASSES, BAMBOOS, RUSHES, and SEDGES.

M. effusum ‘Aureum’ (Bowles’s golden grass, Golden wood millet). Semi-evergreen, tuft-forming, perennial grass. H 3ft (1m), S 1ft (30cm). Has flat, golden-yellow leaves. Produces open, tiered panicles of golden spikelets in summer. Self seeds readily in shady sites. Z5–9

MILLA

ALLIACEAE/LILIACEAE

Genus of summer-flowering bulbs, grown for their fragrant flowers, each comprising a slender tube with 6 star-shaped petals at the tip. Half hardy. Needs a sheltered, sunny position and well-drained soil. Plant in spring. After flowering, lift bulbs and partially dry off for winter. Propagate by seed or by offsets in spring.

M. biflora. Summer-flowering bulb. H 1–1½ft (30–45cm), S 3–4in (8–10cm). Has long, narrow, semierect, basal leaves. Stem bears a loose head of 1–8 erect, white or white-flushed, pink or lilac flowers, 1¼–2½in (3–6cm) across, each on a long, slender stalk. Z10–11

MILTONIA

ORCHIDACEAE

See also ORCHIDS.

M. candida. Evergreen, epiphytic orchid for a cool or intermediate greenhouse. H 8in (20cm). Has narrowly ovate leaves, 4–5in (10–12cm) long, and spikes of cream or pink-lipped, greenish-yellow flowers, patterned chestnut-brown, 2in (5cm) across, in fall. Needs partial shade in summer. Z11–12 (min. 55°F/13°C; max. 86°F/30°C)
M. clowesii. Evergreen, epiphytic orchid for an intermediate greenhouse. H 8in (20cm). Has broadly ovate leaves, 1ft (30cm) long. In fall, bears large spikes of yellow flowers, 1½in (4cm) across, barred with reddish-brown and with a white-and-mauve lip. Grow in partial shade in summer. Z11–12 (min. 55°F/13°C; max. 86°F/30°C)

MILTONIOPSIS

Pansy orchid

ORCHIDACEAE

See also ORCHIDS.

M. Anjou gx ‘St. Patrick’ (illus. p.467). Evergreen, epiphytic orchid for a cool greenhouse. H 6in (15cm). Narrowly ovate, soft leaves are 4–5in (10–12cm) long. Has sprays of deep crimson flowers, 4in (10cm) across, with red-orange and white patterns on the lip, mainly in summer. Needs shade in summer. Z11–12 (min. 52°F/11°C; max. 75°F/24°C)
M. Robert Strauss gx ‘Ardingly’ (illus. p.466). Evergreen, epiphytic orchid for a cool greenhouse. H 6in (15cm). Narrowly ovate, soft leaves are 4–5in (10–12cm) long. Bears sprays of white flowers, 4in (10cm) across, marked reddish-brown and purple, mainly in summer. Needs shade in summer. Z11–12 (min. 52°F/11°C; max. 75°F/24°C)

MIMOSA

MIMOSACEAE/LEGUMINOSAE

Genus of annuals, evergreen perennials, shrubs, trees, and scrambling climbers, cultivated for their flowers and foliage. *M. pudica* is usually grown as an annual. Frost tender. Needs partial shade and fertile, well-drained soil. Water potted specimens freely when in full growth, moderately at other times. Propagate by seed in spring, shrubs also by semiripe cuttings in summer. Red spider mite may be a nuisance.

M. pudica (Humble plant, Sensitive plant) illus. p.457.

MIMULUS

Monkey flower, Musk

PHRYMACEAE/SCROPHULARIACEAE

Genus of annuals, perennials, and evergreen shrubs. Small species suit damp pockets in rock gardens. Fully hardy to frost tender. Most prefer full sun and wet or moist soil; some require a dry site. Propagate perennials by division in spring, shrubs by softwood cuttings in late summer; annuals and all species by seed in fall or early spring.

M. ‘Andean Nymph’. See *M. naiandinus*.
M. aurantiacus. See *Diplacus aurantiacus*.

M. cupreus ‘Whitecroft Scarlet’, syn. *M. ‘Whitecroft Scarlet’*. Short-lived, spreading perennial. H 8–12in (20–30cm), S 1ft (30cm). Has ovate, toothed, mid-green leaves. Bears snapdragonlike, scarlet flowers freely from early to late summer. Z8–10

M. glutinosus. See *Diplacus aurantiacus*.
M. guttatus, syn. *M. langsdorffii*. Upright to spreading, mat-forming perennial. H and S 2ft (60cm). Ovate leaves are coarsely or sometimes deeply toothed and mid-green. Snapdragonlike, bright yellow flowers, spotted with reddish-brown on lower lobes, are produced in succession in summer and early fall. Z5–10

M. x hybridus cultivars. Erect, basally branching, bushy, perennials, often grown as annuals. H 5–12in (12–30cm), S to 1ft (30cm). Ovate, toothed leaves are mid-to dark green. Tubular, open-mouthed, brightly colored, usually spotted flowers, with lobed lips, are borne in summer. Z6–9. **Magic Series** cultivars, H 6–8in (15–20cm), are early-flowering, with small flowers ranging in hue from bright orange, yellow, and red to more usual pastel shades and bicolors. **‘Magic Yellow Blotch’** illus. p.322. **Maximus Series**, H and S to 10in (25cm), are vigorous and upright, with large flowers, 2½in (6cm) across, in a range of colors.

M. langsdorffii. See *M. guttatus*.

M. lewisii. Upright perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Has downy, sticky, gray leaves that provide an excellent foil for snapdragonlike, deep rose-pink, sometimes white, flowers borne singly in summer. Z9–11

M. luteus (Monkey musk, Yellow monkey flower). Spreading perennial. H and S 1ft (30cm). Throughout summer, snapdragonlike, occasionally red-spotted, yellow flowers are freely produced above hairy, mid-green foliage. Z6–9

M. moschatus (Musk). Deciduous, prostrate, perennial, bog plant. H 4in (10cm), S 6in (15cm). Has ovate, hairy, pale green leaves. Small, pale yellow flowers, lightly speckled with brown, are borne in late summer. Z6–9

M. naiandinus, syn. *M. ‘Andean Nymph’*, illus. p.264.

M. ringens illus. p.441.

M. ‘Royal Velvet’. Compact perennial, often grown as an annual. H 1ft (30cm), S 9in (23cm). Leaves are mid-green. Bears many large, snapdragonlike, mahogany-